

Some anti-AI folks are going around claiming that we have 13 years of drinkable water left SPECIFICALLY because of AI data centers. Yet their 13-year claim seemed to have no verifiable grounds

Posted by u/Curi0us-Pebble • 0 points • 45 comments

Anyone here knows if this is legit or just another BS misinformation? 🤔

Comments

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2026-04-07 14:37 UTC

[removed]

u/Curi0us-Pebble • 1 points • 2026-04-07 15:24 UTC

<https://preview.redd.it/abfhrp5jdstg1.jpeg?width=1080&format=pjpg&auto=webp&s=0dd701d4225ad5eee12663f5f9f440c6e2277234>

u/Curi0us-Pebble • 1 points • 2026-04-07 15:12 UTC

From Google:

>**Agriculture** is the **single largest consumer** of freshwater, accounting for **approximately 70%** of global water withdrawals. This immense demand is driven by the need to sustain a growing global population, with irrigation alone responsible for about 60% of those withdrawals.

[Source](<https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S3050475925011583>)

Agriculture uses 70% of our water. That is A LOT of water. AI data centers are a drop in the bucket by comparison. Even if we turned them all off tomorrow, it wouldn't solve the shortage. Imo, blaming AI for the entire water crisis is a major exaggeration.

<https://preview.redd.it/c63e535fbstg1.jpeg?width=1080&format=pjpg&auto=webp&s=407c7a3071b9316ee42e0c0f97e5a616b467deed>

u/AutoModerator • 1 points • 2026-04-07 14:37 UTC

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u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2026-04-06 13:31 UTC

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u/Asmordikai • 1 points • 2026-03-03 19:47 UTC

There's literally no scientific claims stating 13 years of water remaining.

u/Impressive-Wave-1231 • 0 points • 2026-02-25 00:15 UTC

something that nobody is considering in this discussion is the fact that food is one of the basic necessities in life that people need to actually live, and ai is faaaarr from a necessity. just because youve gotten so lazy that you think you need a machine to think for you doesn't mean you actually need that machine to live. agriculture is a major source of food production, food that people need. like. actually need. quit spitting out that same "source?" bullshit and use common sense.

u/Curi0us-Pebble • 1 points • 2026-02-25 02:02 UTC

I mean, if you're gonna make a bold, supposedly "factual" claim that we have 13 years of freshwater left BECAUSE of AI data centers, then you do need to accompany that statement with valid sources. Otherwise your claim is just pure bullshit. Anyone can make up numbers.

u/Jphibbard • 2 points • 2026-02-23 14:51 UTC

Here is what AI says about that so

The world has entered an era of "global water bankruptcy," with many regions depleting groundwater faster than it can be replenished, according to a January 2026 UN University report (<https://unu.edu/inweh/news/world-enters-era-of-global-water-bankruptcy>). While not a total, global "running out" of water in 13 years, critical aquifers are projected to hit "peak water" around 2050, making water too expensive or scarce to extract in regions like the US, India, and China. [1, 2, 3, 4]
Key Findings on Water Scarcity

- Global Water Bankruptcy: The UN indicates many systems are beyond a crisis and into a state of permanent "bankruptcy," meaning they cannot return to previous, higher water levels.
- Peak Water by 2050: Studies suggest that by roughly 2050, groundwater extraction will reach an irreversible decline, impacting over half the global population.
- Regional "Day Zero" Threats: Some communities may experience "Day Zero" (running out of water) much sooner due to infrastructure failure and mismanagement, as seen in water-stressed areas globally.
- Causes of Depletion: Unprecedented freshwater loss is driven by climate change, unsustainable groundwater use, and increasing demands from agriculture and industry (<https://www.facebook.com/PBSDigitalStudios/videos/when-will-the-world-run-out-of-water-weathered/745310741449547/>). [2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9]

While the "13-year" figure often refers to alarmist or misinterpreted projections regarding specific, localized, or high-demand scenarios (such as AI data centers), the underlying data confirms that severe, long-term water stress is a present reality for many. [10, 11]

AI responses may include mistakes.

[1] <https://www.smithsonianmag.com/smart-news/united-nations-declares-that-the-world-has-entered-an-era-of-global-water-bankruptcy-180988045/>

[2] <https://news.un.org/en/story/2026/01/1166800>

[3] <https://www.facebook.com/PBSDigitalStudios/videos/when-will-the-world-run-out-of-water->

weathered/745310741449547/

[4] <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-ILJlhWDMc>

[5] <https://unu.edu/inweh/news/world-enters-era-of-global-water-bankruptcy>

[6] <https://www.facebook.com/ScienceNaturePage/posts/new-research-shows-the-worlds-water-is-running-out-a-sweeping-new-study-warns-th/1406637287583803/>

[7] <https://www.ecoticias.com/en/goodbye-to-drinking-water-day-zero-will-arrive-sooner-than-you-thought-and-science-already-knows-when-and-where-it-will-happen/25735/>

[8] <https://news.asu.edu/20250725-environment-and-sustainability-new-global-study-shows-freshwater-disappearing-alarming>

[9] <https://www.unep.org/news-and-stories/story/climate-dries-american-west-faces-problematic-future-experts-warn>

[10] https://www.reddit.com/r/DefendingAIArt/comments/1r7xgey/some_antiai_folks_are_going_around_claiming_that/

[11] <https://www.msn.com/en-us/lifestyle/lifestyle-buzz/residents-of-us-community-outraged-after-learning-why-their-water-supply-suddenly-ran-dry-who-is-going-to-compensate-us/ar-AA1WwIP8?ocid=zdhp>